

Robert (Bob) Wade

Engineering leader | Platform & reliability | Partner & product | AI-augmented ops

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Engineering Manager at Button owning two engineering functions, Core Engineering and Solutions Engineering, and 13 engineers behind \$100B+ in mobile commerce for Amazon, Walmart, Uber, Lyft, Fetch, and Sam's Club. 19 years in engineering, 10+ in management. I take over unstable orgs and leave behind reliable, automated systems: rebuilt on-call to 99.99% uptime, held the platform through a Super Bowl at 2.6x its planned peak with errors flat, and run delivery increasingly on AI-augmented workflows. Also found and run commerce businesses end to end, from engineering and product to brand and design.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership: Multi-function org design, Multi-team Agile ceremonies, Hiring and bar setting, Coaching and career development, Performance management, PERM sponsorship, Exec and VP reporting

Platform reliability: Incident command, On-call and PagerDuty, Blameless postmortems, SLAs, Observability, Peak load readiness

Partner engineering: Enterprise integrations, Escalation management, Attribution and event pipelines, Retail media

Product and delivery: Roadmapping and release planning, Backlog and capacity planning, Feasibility and scoping gates, Cross-functional delivery across product, revenue, and support

Design and UX: Brand and logo design, UI/UX, Figma, Front-end build

AI and automation: Claude and MCP, Custom MCP servers, Agentic PRD to ticket pipelines, Generative creative

Backend and data: Go, Python, Node.js, Postgres, Aurora, MongoDB, BigQuery

Frontend: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Tailwind

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (ECS, EC2, RDS/Aurora, S3, SES, Route 53), GCP, Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineering Manager, Core Engineering & Solutions Engineering

Button, Inc. | Remote (NYC) | Oct 2021 - Present

Own two engineering functions and 13 direct reports: Core Engineering (routing, attribution, data, infrastructure) and Solutions Engineering (partner delivery and technical escalation), covering the platform behind \$100B+ in driven mobile commerce and routing 130M+ Amazon creator clicks a month across 200+ brands including Amazon, Walmart, Uber, Lyft, Fetch, Target, and Sam's Club. I own both the platform and the partner handoff that most orgs split and drop.

- My team owns the core infrastructure that makes Button run: the routing, decisioning, attribution, and order pipeline every partner and dollar flows through. I hold the RTB/KTLO mandate for it, covering reliability, tech debt, and operational load for systems moving \$100B+ in commerce.
- Lead Amazon Prime Day readiness year over year, Button's largest revenue event: capacity planning, load testing, and Go/No-Go across the core services, scaling infrastructure up to 12x baseline and proving headroom for each larger ramp at 100% uptime.
- Incident commander through Fetch's Super Bowl, holding the platform at 2.6x its planned peak with errors within normal limits. Rebuilt on-call, severity, and blameless postmortems from scratch, sustaining 99.99% uptime and cutting MTTR.

- Cut core engineering interrupts about 30% by standing up a Support to Data to Core escalation flow, converting reactive firefighting into protected delivery capacity.
- Own Button's order pipeline, the platform's revenue path at 600K+ orders a day. Drove autoscaling, Aurora migrations, and ComStore and Django modernization, and led the release-confidence program (staging parity plus end-to-end testing) that cut release cycles from roughly two months to about three weeks. Backed cost discipline including a single AWS saving of roughly \$70K a year.
- Sponsored internal read-only LLM tooling, a Sam's Club order debugger and a CSV validator, that cut manual triage load. Built with tightly scoped tools to prevent hallucination.
- Championed AI-augmented delivery. Org-wide, Claude-attributed code reached about 45% of lines shipped and roughly two thirds of merged PRs.
- Stood up Button's partner-support function from scratch, taking support from 100% ad hoc (Slack DMs and email, no ownership or routing) to a structured, SLA-backed operation.
- Architected the Salesforce to Zendesk to Jira model, with Zendesk as the source of truth for routing, prioritization, and SLAs, and formed a Support Engineering team to own it.
- Defined tiered SLAs and the incident priority matrix across strategic partners (Uber, Amazon, Best Buy, Sam's Club, Fetch): P0 acknowledged in under 15 minutes, 30-minute response for Tier 1, plus the escalation decision tree routing work across Solutions Engineering, Data, and on-call.
- Solutions Engineering landed and scaled integrations across a who's-who of commerce, travel, and marketplace: Amazon, Walmart, Best Buy, Target, Sam's Club, Nike, Lululemon, Puma, Samsung, Expedia, Marriott, Uber One, Lyft, Disney+, and StubHub, including the Sam's Club Glass and mParticle migration.
- Cut enterprise integration onboarding time 30% and raised revenue per integration 20% by standardizing the integration path and removing bespoke per partner engineering.
- Led formation and initial delivery of Button's retail media product: set the roadmap and release plan with product and revenue, and shipped initial releases with NY Post, Forbes, and BuzzFeed.
- Act as engineering manager, product manager, and scrum lead for my org: own the roadmap, backlog prioritization, quarterly capacity planning, and the full Agile cadence across multiple squads, plus the feasibility gate between Revenue, Product, and Engineering on what actually gets built.
- Early on, led Button's PostTap product engineering and ran half the org through the post-COVID rebuild.
- Built the team I now run and lead through managers, not only ICs: a Solutions Engineering leader on the director track reports to me directly. Raised the hiring bar, authored the career-growth ladder and design-review process, and sponsored a PERM labor certification end to end.

Founder & Principal

Digital Tide | Remote | Mar 2025 - Present

Independent consultancy where I found and run businesses end to end, wearing every hat: product, engineering, business, growth, and design. I stand companies up (entity, cloud, email, go to market), build the apps, and take on brand and design work where it is mine to do. Selected engagements are listed below.

- Sanbar (sanbar.us): built the client's entire technical foundation, covering GCP and AWS infrastructure, DNS, email and identity, the deployment pipeline, and the production site.
- That Paleo Chick (thatpaleochick.com): built the business, not just the site. AWS infrastructure, transactional and marketing email, social content produced and scheduled automatically through Postiz, and affiliate monetization, running as a near fully automated operation.
- Greedy: ran the full site redesign end to end, from scope through vendors to launch, and own social and paid acquisition, including a competitive playbook built from live Meta Ad Library teardowns and AI generated video creative.

- Charter: designed and built an invoicing application solo, covering auth, billing entities, invoice generation, and payment tracking.
- Design and brand: designed the brand and logo for Digital Tide and That Paleo Chick, plus the UI and UX for the apps I have shipped.
- Digital Tide (digitalti.de): the same playbook applied to my own firm, plus the standards clients inherit, meaning Linear first delivery, GitHub Actions CI, and Slack automation.

IT Manager, Engineering Chapter

Centene Corporation | St. Louis, MO | Jan 2019 - Oct 2021

- Led 25 engineers across seven cross functional Agile teams delivering member facing web and mobile applications and new health plan implementations.
- Built the standard engineering process layer for all web and mobile matrix teams, and defined the metrics leadership used for staffing and prioritization.
- Created a Developer Assessment Framework that made role expectations explicit. Top 10% employee engagement across web leadership teams.

IT Manager, Member AI & Mobile, then Senior Application Software Engineer

Centene Corporation | St. Louis, MO | Sep 2014 - Jan 2019

- Built and led the cross functional team that shipped a self service AI health assistant, reducing call center volume, and established the SDLC framework for the inherited application.
- Delivered more than 20 mobile applications across iOS and Android, launched care management in the Florida market, and standardized mobile build, release, and compliance for state contracts.
- As Senior Engineer: shipped OAuth 2.0 via API Gateway, migrated the org from SVN to Git, and mentored about 10 engineers.

EARLIER

Software Engineer / Web Producer, Centene, 2013 - 2014

Team Lead, Visual Design, N-Depth Solutions, 2008 - 2013

Web Developer, Clear Pages, 2007 - 2008

EDUCATION

A.A.S., Multimedia & Web Design, St. Charles Community College, 2004 - 2007

CERTIFICATIONS

ITIL Foundation, AXELOS

Leadership Development Program, Centene